

From Pharmacist to Coder

Vocabulary, Grammar, and Comprehension Handout

Intermediate Level

THE TEXT (Improved Version)

Note: This version improves clarity and flow while preserving the original voice and meaning.

When I decided to become a pharmacist for my first job, I also made a bold decision to learn coding at the same time. It was not because medicine no longer gave me passion and motivation, but because I wanted a career that was not limited by time and space — and I gradually realized that focusing solely on medicine and pharmacy would not lead me there. Before embarking on this journey, the goal was simple: work hard at the pharmacy, study hard on coding after work. But as I started down the path, I found that this seemingly simple plan was actually mission impossible. Being nearly a complete beginner, my hours after work were already filled with clinical studies, which drastically cut into my time for coding. On top of that, as AI grew increasingly powerful, I began to doubt my initial decision. Was the money worth it? Was the time worth it? A function that took me hours or even days to build from scratch could be done by AI in less than ten minutes. The difficulties I encountered and the realization of AI's capabilities left me feeling truly depressed for a while — until something began to shift at work.

As my skills accumulated and I achieved strong performance in the workplace, I was assigned the role of research pharmacist instead of purely dispensing medication. This shift in position gave me more space and time to explore new skills and possibilities. One project I am working on is a nearly mature educational system that teaches pharmacists how to conduct analysis in clinical studies. Beyond that, I am also trying to build a system that converts slides and PDF files into short podcasts, allowing pharmacists to listen during their free time. These are real challenges, and I do feel nervous about completing them. Yet despite the anxiety and fear, I find that I am able to

keep moving forward. I am not sure where these experiments will ultimately lead, but the eight hours I spend at work now feel more meaningful and fulfilling. They give me a way to contribute to my workplace by building genuinely useful tools that no other engineer could create. Becoming a true software engineer may not be the path I ultimately take, but I am glad I went down this road and built a whole new identity and role that I never could have imagined before.

PART A: VOCABULARY (12 Words)

Study the following vocabulary words from the text. Pay attention to how each word is used in context.

#	Word	Definition & Example from Text
1	bold (adj.)	showing courage and confidence; not afraid to take risks. "I also made a bold decision to learn coding."
2	solely (adv.)	only; without anything or anyone else. "Focusing solely on medicine and pharmacy would not lead me there."
3	drastically (adv.)	in a severe or extreme way. "Which drastically cut into my time for coding."
4	initial (adj.)	existing or occurring at the beginning. "I began to doubt my initial decision."
5	from scratch (phr.)	from the very beginning, without using anything already made. "A function that took me hours to build from scratch."
6	capability (n.)	the power or ability to do something. "The realization of AI's capabilities left me feeling truly depressed."
7	depressed (adj.)	feeling very sad and without hope. "Left me feeling truly depressed for a while."
8	shift (n.)	a change in position, direction, or situation. "This shift in position gave me more space and time."
9	conduct (v.)	to carry out or organize an activity. "Teaches pharmacists how to conduct analysis in clinical studies."
10	convert (v.)	to change something from one form to another. "A system that converts slides and PDF files into short podcasts."
11	contribute (v.)	to give something valuable to help achieve a goal. "They give me a way to contribute to my workplace."
12	ultimately (adv.)	in the end; finally. "May not be the path I ultimately take."

PART B: GRAMMAR (4 Patterns)

Study the following grammar structures from the text.

Pattern 1: "despite + noun / gerund"

Form: Despite + noun / gerund (-ing form), + subject + verb

Use: To show that something happens even though there is a difficulty or obstacle.

Example from text: *"Yet despite the anxiety and fear, I find that I am able to keep moving forward."*

More examples:

- Despite the heavy rain, they continued playing soccer.
- Despite failing the first test, she did not give up.
- Despite his lack of experience, he performed well in the interview.

Pattern 2: "allow + object + to + verb"

Form: Subject + allow(s) + object + to + base verb

Use: To express that something makes it possible for someone to do something.

Example from text: *"A system that converts slides and PDF files into short podcasts, allowing pharmacists to listen during their free time."*

More examples:

- The new schedule allows employees to work from home on Fridays.
- This app allows users to track their spending easily.
- The scholarship allowed her to attend university without financial worry.

Pattern 3: Wh- noun clause (as object)

Form: Subject + verb + wh-word (where/what/how/why/who) + subject + verb

Use: To express uncertainty or indirect questions within a sentence.

Example from text: *"I am not sure where these experiments will ultimately lead."*

More examples:

- I don't know what he is planning to do next.
- She couldn't decide which university to apply to.
- We need to figure out how this machine works.

Pattern 4: "may not... but..."

Form: Subject + may not + verb + ..., but + subject + verb + ...

Use: To acknowledge a limitation or imperfection while expressing something positive.

Example from text: *"Becoming a true software engineer may not be the path I ultimately take, but I am glad I went down this road."*

More examples:

- This job may not pay the most, but it gives me the freedom I need.
- The result may not be perfect, but I learned a great deal from the process.
- She may not be the fastest runner, but her determination always gets her to the finish line.

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer to complete each sentence.

1. Starting a business on your own is a _____ move, but it can pay off.
 - a) depressed
 - b) bold
 - c) initial
 - d) sole

2. The fire _____ reduced the forest to ashes in just two days.
 - a) ultimately
 - b) solely
 - c) drastically
 - d) initially

3. The project's failure was not _____ due to poor planning; other factors played a role too.
 - a) boldly
 - b) drastically
 - c) initially
 - d) solely

4. She wanted to bake the cake _____, without using a store-bought mix.
 - a) from scratch
 - b) ultimately
 - c) drastically
 - d) initially

5. His _____ reaction was shock, but he quickly calmed down.

- a) bold
- b) depressed
- c) initial
- d) sole

6. Modern technology has the _____ to transform entire industries.

- a) shift
- b) contribution
- c) capability
- d) conduct

7. After failing the exam three times, he felt _____ and wanted to give up.

- a) bold
- b) initial
- c) sole
- d) depressed

8. There has been a major _____ in public opinion over the past decade.

- a) shift
- b) capability
- c) conduct
- d) conversion

9. The scientist was invited to _____ research at a university in London.

- a) convert
- b) contribute
- c) conduct
- d) shift

10. This machine can _____ sunlight into electricity.

- a) contribute
- b) conduct
- c) shift
- d) convert

11. She wants to _____ to the community by volunteering every weekend.

- a) convert
- b) contribute
- c) conduct
- d) shift

12. He tried many different careers, but _____ found his passion in teaching.

- a) drastically
- b) solely
- c) boldly
- d) ultimately

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

Word Bank: bold, solely, drastically, initial, from scratch, capability, depressed, shift, conduct, convert, contribute, ultimately

1. The weather changed _____, and we had to cancel the outdoor event.
2. He built his website _____, learning every line of code himself.
3. Don't feel _____; everyone faces setbacks at some point.
4. The school hired a new teacher to _____ the science experiments.
5. She made a _____ choice to quit her stable job and travel the world.
6. My _____ plan was to study law, but I ended up choosing medicine.
7. You can _____ old T-shirts into cleaning rags instead of throwing them away.
8. Each team member should _____ at least one idea during the meeting.
9. The _____ in management brought a completely new working style.
10. This phone has the _____ to run complex software smoothly.
11. Success is not _____ about talent; hard work matters too.
12. She tried several solutions and _____ found one that worked.

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer to complete each sentence.

1. Despite _____ very tired, she finished all her homework before bed.
 - a) be
 - b) being
 - c) was
 - d) been

2. The new policy allows students _____ their own research topics.
 - a) choosing
 - b) chose
 - c) to choose
 - d) chosen

3. I still don't understand _____ he changed his mind so suddenly.
 - a) what
 - b) why
 - c) that
 - d) which

4. The weather may not _____ perfect for hiking, but we should still go.
 - a) is
 - b) being
 - c) was
 - d) be

5. Despite the _____ schedule, he managed to finish the project on time.
 - a) tight

- b) tightly
- c) tighten
- d) tightness

6. The teacher allows her students _____ dictionaries during the test.

- a) use
- b) using
- c) to use
- d) used

7. She hasn't decided _____ she wants to study abroad or stay home.

- a) that
- b) what
- c) whether
- d) which

8. This apartment may not be the biggest, _____ the location is excellent.

- a) so
- b) and
- c) or
- d) but

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

Rewrite each sentence using the pattern indicated in parentheses.

despite + noun / gerund

1. It rained heavily, but they still went to the park. (Despite...)

→ _____

2. She had no experience, but she got the job. (Despite...)

→ _____

allow + object + to + verb

3. Because of the new rule, students can leave campus during lunch. (The new rule allows...)

→ _____

4. This software makes it possible for doctors to access patient records from home. (This software allows...)

→ _____

wh- noun clause

5. Where did he go? Nobody knows. (Nobody knows...)

→ _____

6. How does she manage her time so well? I have always wondered. (I have always wondered...)

→ _____

may not... but...

7. I am not the smartest student in the class. However, I always try my best. (I may not...)

→ _____

8. This phone is not the newest model. However, it still works perfectly. (This phone may not...)

→ _____

Comprehension Questions

Answer the following questions based on the text.

1. Why did the author decide to learn coding in addition to being a pharmacist?

→ _____

→ _____

2. What made the author's plan of studying coding after work so difficult?

→ _____

→ _____

3. Why did the rise of AI make the author doubt the decision to learn coding?

→ _____

→ _____

4. How did the author's role at work change, and what effect did this have?

→ _____

→ _____

5. What two projects is the author currently working on?

→ _____

→ _____

6. How does the author feel about the journey overall, despite the challenges?

→ _____

→ _____

Conversation Questions

Theme: Adapting to Change in Your Career

1. Have you ever had to learn a completely new skill for your job or studies? What was it, and how did you feel at the beginning?
2. The author felt depressed when AI could do the work faster. Have you ever felt discouraged when you realized something could be done more easily by technology or someone else? How did you handle it?
3. The author's role changed from dispensing pharmacist to research pharmacist. Do you think it is important to be open to unexpected changes in your career path? Why or why not?
4. The author says the eight hours at work feel more meaningful now. What makes work or study feel meaningful to you personally?
5. The author built a new identity by combining pharmacy with technology. Do you think combining different skills from different fields is becoming more important in today's world? What combination of skills would you like to develop?

ANSWER KEY

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. b) bold 2. c) drastically 3. d) solely 4. a) from scratch 5. c) initial 6. c) capability 7. d) depressed 8. a) shift 9. c) conduct 10. d) convert 11. b) contribute 12. d) ultimately

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

1. drastically 2. from scratch 3. depressed 4. conduct 5. bold 6. initial 7. convert 8. contribute 9. shift 10. capability 11. solely 12. ultimately

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. b) being 2. c) to choose 3. b) why 4. d) be 5. a) tight 6. c) to use 7. c) whether 8. d) but

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation (Sample Answers)

1. Despite the heavy rain, they still went to the park.
2. Despite having no experience, she got the job.
3. The new rule allows students to leave campus during lunch.
4. This software allows doctors to access patient records from home.
5. Nobody knows where he went.
6. I have always wondered how she manages her time so well.
7. I may not be the smartest student in the class, but I always try my best.
8. This phone may not be the newest model, but it still works perfectly.

Comprehension Questions (Sample Answers)

1. Because the author wanted a career not limited by time and space, and realized that focusing solely on medicine and pharmacy would not lead to that goal.
2. The hours after work were already filled with clinical studies, leaving very little time for coding.
3. Because AI could do in minutes what took the author hours or days to build, making the effort feel less worthwhile.

4. The author was promoted from dispensing pharmacist to research pharmacist, which provided more space and time to explore new skills and projects.
5. An educational system that teaches pharmacists how to conduct clinical analysis, and a system that converts slides and PDFs into short podcasts for pharmacists.
6. The author is glad to have taken the path, as it led to a more meaningful and fulfilling work experience and a new identity that was previously unimaginable.